

CHIONANTHUS

well-drained, but not too dry soil. Propagate by seed in fall.
C. retusus (Chinese fringe tree). Deciduous, often treelike, arching shrub. H and S 10ft (3m). From early to midsummer, star-shaped, pure white flowers are borne in large clusters amid ovate, bright green leaves. Z3–9
C. virginicus (Fringe tree) illus. p.112.

CHIONOCHLOA

POACEAE/GRAMINEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES.
C. conspicua (Plumed tussock grass). Evergreen, tussock-forming, perennial grass. H 4–5ft (1.2–1.5m), S 3ft (1m). Very long, mid-green leaves are tinged reddish-brown. Has sturdy, arching stems with long, loose, open panicles of cream spikelets in summer. Z8–10
C. rubra illus. p.285.

Chionodoxa. See *Scilla*.
x Chionoscilla. See *Scilla*.
Chirita sinensis. See *Primulina dryas*.

CHLIDANTHUS

AMARYLLIDACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering bulbs, grown for their showy, strongly scented flowers. Needs a sunny site and well-drained soil. Plant in the open after flowering; if necessary, lift and dry off for winter. Propagate by offsets in spring.
C. fragrans illus. p.424.

CHLOROGALUM

Soap plant

ASPAGACEAE

Genus of late spring- and summer-flowering bulbs, grown more for botanical interest than for floral display, although they produce elegant sprays of flowers. Requires sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in fall or spring.
C. pomeridianum. Summer-flowering bulb. H to 8ft (2.5m), S 6–8in (15–20cm). Semierect, basal leaves are long, narrow and gray-green, with wavy margins. Produces a large, loosely branched head of small, saucer-shaped, white flowers, with a central, green or purple stripe on each petal, that open after midday. Z9–11

CHLOROPHYTUM

ASPAGACEAE

Genus of evergreen, stemless perennials with short rhizomes. Ideal for growing in containers and hanging baskets; they are popular foliage houseplants. Grow in a light position, away from direct sun, in fertile, well-drained soil. Water freely in growing season, but sparingly at other times if pot-grown. Propagate by seed, division or plantlets (produced on flower stems of some species) at any time except winter.
C. capense. Evergreen, tufted perennial. H 12in (30cm), S indefinite. Forms rosettes of lance- or strap-shaped, bright green leaves, to 2ft (60cm) long. Tiny, white flowers in racemes, to 2ft (60cm) long, are borne in summer. Does not produce

plantlets. Z10–11 (min. 45°F/7°C)
C. capense of gardens. See *C. comosum*.
C. comosum, syn. *C. capense* of gardens (Ribbon plant, Spider plant). Evergreen, tufted perennial. H 12in (30cm), S indefinite. Very narrow leaves, to 18in (45cm) long, spread from a rosette. Racemes of many small, star-shaped, white flowers are borne on thin stems, 2ft (60cm) or more long, at any time. Small rosettes of leaves may be produced on flower stems, forming plantlets. Z10–12. (min. 41°F/5°C). **‘Vittatum’** illus. p.465.

CHOISYA

Mexican orange blossom

RUTACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs, grown for their attractive, aromatic foliage and for their fragrant, star-shaped flowers. Best grown in a shrub border or against a wall. Requires full sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in late summer.
C. ‘Aztec Pearl’. See *C. x dewitteana ‘Aztec Pearl’*.
C. x dewitteana ‘Aztec Pearl’ illus. p.122. **WHITE DAZZLER (‘Londaz’)** is an elegant, compact, rounded shrub. H and S to 3ft (1m). Has aromatic, dark green leaves divided into 3–5 narrow leaflets. In late spring, bears a profusion of fragrant, snow-white flowers, in clusters of 3–5 in the leaf axils, and flowers again in late summer. Z7–10
C. ternata (Mexican orange blossom) illus. p.122. **SUNDANCE (‘Lich’)** illus. p.148.

Chordospartium. See *Carmichaelia*.

CHORISIA

MALVACEAE

Genus of deciduous or semievergreen, succulent trees, usually with spine-covered trunks, grown mainly for their flowers in fall and winter and their overall appearance. Needs full light and well-drained soil. Water containerized specimens freely when in full growth, very little when leafless. Pruning is tolerated if necessary. Propagate by seed in spring. Red spider mite may be troublesome.
C. speciosa, syn. *Ceiba speciosa* (Floss silk tree), illus. p.450.

CHORIZEMA

PAPILIONACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of small, evergreen shrubs and twining or scandent climbers, grown mainly for their flowers. Requires full light and humus-rich, well-drained, sandy soil, preferably neutral to acidic. Water potted plants moderately, less hen not in full growth. Tie climbers to supports, or grow in hanging baskets. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer.
C. ilicifolium (Holly flame pea) illus. p.454.

Chrysalidocarpus lutescens. See *Dypsis lutescens*.

CHRYSANTHEMUM

SYN. AJANIA, DENDRANTHEMA

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of upright, sometimes woody-based herbaceous perennials. Chrysanthemums are grown primarily for their showy flower heads, 1–12in (2.5–30cm) across, which consist of ray-florets in a variety of colors, including yellow, white, pink, purple and red, with yellow disc-florets; they are cultivated in a multiplicity of forms. The dark green leaves are shallowly to deeply lobed or cut, ovate to lance-shaped, and often feathery. Lift marginally hardy or frost-tender florists’ chrysanthemums and store in a frost-free place over winter. Provide a sunny site and reasonably fertile, well-drained soil. Plants grown for exhibition require regular feeding. Pinch out growing tips to encourage flowering sideshoots; stake tall plants with canes. Propagate annuals by seed sown *in situ* in spring; thin out, but do not transplant. Propagate hardy perennials by division in fall, after flowering, or in early spring; florists’ chrysanthemums by basal softwood cuttings in spring. Aphids, capsids, froghoppers, earwigs, mildew, and white rust may be troublesome.

Florists’ chrysanthemums

These perennial cultivars are available in a wide range of forms and colors, and are grown for exhibition, the garden and cutting. They are often categorized according to their flower head form (see feature panel pp.252–253), their flowering season—early (late summer and early fall), mid-season (midfall), or late (midfall to midwinter)—and whether they are disbudded or non-disbudded (see below). The best groups for outdoor use are the early-flowering spray chrysanthemums, reflexed cultivars, and pompom chrysanthemums. Some midseason reflexed cultivars are suitable for garden use, but most need protection from rain. Late-flowering cultivars are brought into flower in a temperate or warm greenhouse.

Disbudded—these chrysanthemums have all the flower buds on each shoot removed except for the terminal bud, to increase the size of the remaining bloom. They are classified by exhibitors into size groups. For exhibition, those with incurved, intermediate or reflexed flowers are restricted to 2 blooms per plant; in gardens, 4 or 5 blooms are allowed to develop. Single and anemone-centered flowers are reduced to 4 to 8 blooms for exhibition, and 10 or more for garden use and for cutting.

Non-disbudded—the buds of these chrysanthemums are usually allowed to develop freely. Non-disbudded chrysanthemums are grouped according to size and habit.

Spray chrysanthemums produce several blooms per stem in a variety of flower forms: single, intermediate, reflexed, anemone-centered, pompom, spoon-shaped, or quill-shaped. They are grown mainly for garden decoration and for cutting. For exhibition, each plant is allowed to develop 4 or 5 stems, each bearing 5 or more flower heads. Late-

flowering sprays are restricted to 3 stems; for exhibition, each stem should bear 6 or 7 blooms or, if grown with controlled day length, 12 blooms per stem; for exhibition, the central bud of the spray is usually removed to give a more rounded outline.

Charm chrysanthemums have a dwarf, bushy, domed to almost spherical habit, and bear hundreds of single flower heads, to 1in (25cm) across. They do not need stopping or training, and are grown for indoor decoration, for exhibition, and as bonsai plants.

Cascade chrysanthemums have similar flower heads to charms, but are trained as fans, pillars, pyramids or cascades. They are grown for indoor decoration, for exhibition, and as bonsai plants.

Pompom chrysanthemums are dwarf and bushy, producing 50 or more dense, spherical, or occasionally hemispherical flower heads per plant. They suit an outdoor border.

Semipompom chrysanthemums, sometimes called Japanese pompoms, have similar flowers to those of the pompom, but their yellow centers are revealed as they mature.

Rubellum Group chrysanthemums These are clump-forming, woody-based, bushy perennials. All are named selections or hybrids of *C. zawadzki*. They have cut leaves, often with a silvery cast, and bear single, semidouble, or double, yellow-centered flower heads in a range of colors. Blooming in late summer and early fall, they are good for a herbaceous border and for cutting.

Korean Group chrysanthemums These are similar to the Rubellum Group chrysanthemums, but the cultivars are dwarfer and hardier.

Pot chrysanthemums

These chrysanthemums, usually unnamed at point of sale, are grown commercially on a large scale. They are mostly late-flowering cultivars brought into bloom by manipulation of temperature and day length, and treated with dwarfing hormone, to form compact, short-jointed plants. They are sold as conservatory or houseplants and are best grown as short-term potted plants.

C. ‘Alison Kirk’. Early, incurved, florists’ chrysanthemum. H 4ft (1.2m), S 1–2ft (30–60cm). Produces white flowers, to 5–6in (12–15cm) across, in early fall. More suitable for exhibition than garden use. Z10–11
C. ‘Allouise Pink’. Early, intermediate, florists’ chrysanthemum. H 4ft (1.2m), S 20–36in (50–100cm). Produces pale yellowish-pink flowers, up to 9in (23cm) across, in early fall. Good for garden use, floristry, and exhibition. Z8–10
C. alpinum. See *Leucanthemopsis alpina*.
C. ‘Anastasia’ (illus. p.253). Early, florists’ outdoor semipompom chrysanthemum. H 2ft (60cm), S 20in (50cm). Has flat-topped, dark purplish-pink flowers, 1¼in (3cm) across, with yellow centers, in midfall. Z6–9
C. ‘Angelic’. Pompom, Korean Group chrysanthemum. H 18in (45cm), S 12in (30cm). In early to midfall, produces flower heads, 1in (25cm) across, that